Rookie pilot crash lands on busy road

By DANIELLE McKAY in Hobart

A TEENAGE pilot walked away without a scratch after a miracle crash landing on one of Hobart's busiest highways yesterday.

Patrick Humphries ***(below)***, 18, dodged houses and cars before gliding under an overpass after his a light-aircraft's engine stalled.

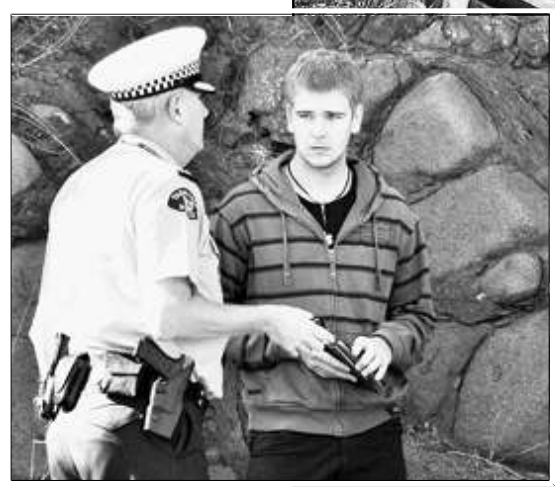
Onlookers were shocked when the Australian Airforce recruit, from Otago Bay in the state's south, stepped out of the wreck ***(right)***, redirecting traffic just seconds after crashing.

The single engine Victa Airtourer stalled during aerobatic training at about 10am, forcing the elite pilot-in-training to circle for several minutes as he made a mayday call and searched for a crash-landing site.

Despite being surrounded by houses, sporting fields and the Derwent River, Mr Humphries skilfully execute a miracle landing, ducking an overpass to land on the Brooker Highway. The aircraft spun out of control after clipping a tree, busting the left landing gear and splitting the left wing in to two pieces, before it crashed into an embankment near well-known Cleary's Gates.

"It just stalled, and circled and circled," eyewitness Robyn Bishop said as she was walking her dog. "It just got lower and lower and I realised he was in trouble."

Resident Nick Probert ***(who took the pictures)***, jumped his back fence after he heard the loud crash, and was one of the first on the scene.



Speedboat tragedies mar event

SYDNEY: A city on the NSW mid-north coast is in shock after an Easter speedboat racing event ended in tragedy with the deaths of two competitors.

People from all over the world flocked to the Manning River at Taree for the 60th anniversary of the Taree Aquatic Power Boat Clubs Easter classic powerboat race.

But the event came to a distressing conclusion when a 44-year-old American man was killed when he was flung from his boat as it travelled at about 200km/h on the Manning River at about 1pm yesterday.

His wife is understood to have looked on as the river was dragged for his body.

He was eventually located and rushed to the Manning Base Hospital but died a short time later.

On Saturday, a man named in several media reports as 61-year-old Brian McCosker from Tamworth died when his powerboat flipped and knocked him unconscious.

Mr McCosker was well-known and respected in the speedboat community.

President of the Australian Power Boat Association Glenn Banks said yesterday he had never seen anything like the double tragedy in the history of the event.

"We've had tragedies before, we've had fatalities before, but never have we lost two of the best competitors in one weekend," he said. The Coroner is investigating both deaths.

Easter toll climbs to 10

SYDNEY: A man died in a car accident in South Australia yesterday, bringing the national toll over the holiday long weekend to 10.

The 20-year-old Peterborough man was a passenger in a car that crashed at Yongala, in the state's mid-north.

The car was carrying five young adults, none of whom were wearing seat belts, police said.

The 23-year-old male driver of the car has been charged with dangerous driving, after he was airlifted to the Royal Adelaide Hospital along with a 20-year-old female passenger.

Their injuries are not believed to be life-threatening.

Meanwhile, in NSW, police are searching for two boys, believed to be aged between 14 and 16, who ran off after an allegedly stolen car crashed in Sydney's west, leaving three injured girls behind.

Supermodel shows off Underbelly

SYDNEY: Australian supermodel Elyse Taylor has exposed her sexy underbelly for a provocative *Vogue* photo shoot alongside *Underbelly 3* star Firass Dirani.

Taylor ***(pictured)***, scantily styled in *Mad Max*-inspired designer fashion, posed for *Vogue* entwined with Dirani, who portrays Kings Cross identity John Ibrahim, a former boyfriend of Taylor's, in the upcoming television series *Underbelly 3: The Golden Mile*.

Already fashion insiders are buzzing that *Vogue*'s risque take on Underbelly's gangster chic will turn the May edition into a best-seller. "Oh great," Taylor laughs over the speculation.

"The shoot is very tongue in cheek and we all went into it laughing at the situation, which was kind of cool," she said.

"Australian magazines are a bit conservative and so it was nice to be able to push it as far as it gets."

Shot over two days in 40C heat, Taylor and Dirani posed together on the sand dunes of Newcastle, one of the original locations for the 1979 iconic movie *Mad Max*.

Although Ibrahim supported her choice to appear in the sexy shoot with Dirani, she concedes intertwining her private life with the media can have a downside.

"A pain really because some parts of your life you just want to keep private, but I do accept that you have to reveal something of your life to make yourself more interesting," Taylor said.

Woman pushed off her bike and injured

MELBOURNE: Police have arrested two teenagers accused of driving past a woman and pushing her from her bike causing serious injuries.

The two males accused of the attack turned up at their local police station afterwards claiming there had been an accident but they were arrested.

The woman was hospitalised following the incident in which she told police she was pushed from her bike by a passing car at Officer, in Melbourne's outer southeast, at noon yesterday.

The 53-year-old woman from Berwick was allegedly riding west on the Princes Highway when a white Commodore travelling in the same direction changed lanes and slowed before the front seat passenger leant out of the window and pushed her.

Sinking feeling for jet ski pair

BRISBANE: A 27-year-old woman whose jet ski sank in Moreton Bay was found after treading water for more than seven hours.

Sharon Jones and her partner Jimmy Jones, 27, went for a jet ski several kilometres off Redcliffe at 7am yesterday when they ran into technical problems.

The jet ski started to sink, forcing the life jacket-wearing duo to abandon the vessel. Mr Jones swam for the shore and was spotted by a passing fisherman.

The search then started for his partner, who was found two hours later after drifting across the bay to Tangalooma.

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